

PassRoute — Texas CDL Practice

Question Bank · 4 core categories · questions, options & answer key (English)

TX Special Requirements · General Knowledge · Air Brakes · Combination Vehicles — 272 questions total

TX Special Requirements · 60 questions

1. What is the maximum legal width of a commercial vehicle or its load in Texas?

- A) 96 inches
- B) 102 inches ✓**
- C) 108 inches
- D) 120 inches

Answer: B — The maximum width, including the load, is 102 inches (8.5 ft); anything wider needs a permit. (§14 Size and Weight)

2. What is the maximum height of a vehicle and load on Texas highways?

- A) 13 ft
- B) 13 ft 6 in
- C) 14 ft ✓**
- D) 15 ft

Answer: C — Maximum height is 14 feet; the driver is responsible for clearing all bridges. (§14 Size and Weight)

3. The maximum gross weight (vehicle plus load) without a permit is:

- A) 72,000 lb
- B) 76,000 lb
- C) 80,000 lb ✓**
- D) 90,000 lb

Answer: C — The maximum gross weight is 80,000 pounds without an overweight permit. (§14 Size and Weight)

4. The slow-moving vehicle (SMV) emblem is for vehicles designed to go:

- A) 15 mph or less
- B) 25 mph or less ✓**
- C) 35 mph or less
- D) 45 mph or less

Answer: B — The orange triangle warns of vehicles built for 25 mph or less. (§14 Special Equipment)

5. On an 80-inch-wide truck, the front clearance lamps must be:

- A) Amber ✓**
- B) Red
- C) White
- D) Green

Answer: A — Front clearance lamps are amber; rear ones are red. (§14 Lighting)

6. The rear clearance lamps on a wide truck must be:

- A) Amber
- B) White
- C) Red ✓**
- D) Blue

Answer: C — Rear clearance lamps and reflectors are red. (§14 Lighting)

7. The two reflectors required on the rear of a CMV must be:

- A) Amber
- B) Red ✓**
- C) White
- D) Green

Answer: B — Rear reflectors are red. (§14 Lighting)

8. Tail lamps must show what color to the rear?

- A) White
- B) Amber
- C) Red ✓**
- D) Blue

Answer: C — Tail lamps show red to the rear. (§14 Lighting)

9. Headlamps on a commercial vehicle must show what color?

- A) Amber
- B) White ✓**
- C) Yellow
- D) Blue

Answer: B — Headlamps must show white light. (§14 Lighting)

10. A red flag marking a projecting load must be at least:

- A) 6 inches square
- B) 9 inches square
- C) 12 inches square ✓**
- D) 18 inches square

Answer: C — The red flag must be at least 12 inches square. (§14 Flags)

11. A load must be flagged when it extends past the rear by more than:

- A) 2 feet
- B) 3 feet
- C) 4 feet ✓**
- D) 6 feet

Answer: C — A red flag is required when the load extends more than 4 feet past the rear. (§14 Flags)

12. A load may not extend beyond the front of the vehicle by more than:

- A) 3 feet ✓**
- B) 4 feet
- C) 6 feet
- D) 10 feet

Answer: A — A load may not extend more than 3 feet past the front. (§14 Load Limits)

13. When towing with a chain, the connection must display a flag that is:

- A) Red
- B) White ✓**
- C) Amber
- D) Orange

Answer: B — A towing chain/rope/cable needs a white flag; red is for projecting loads. (§14 Towing)

14. The towing connection between two vehicles may not be longer than:

- A) 10 feet
- B) 15 feet ✓**
- C) 20 feet
- D) 25 feet

Answer: B — The connection may not exceed 15 feet (except a pole/rigid bar). (§14 Towing)

15. Trailer brakes on the rear axle are required over a gross weight of:

- A) 2,500 lb
- B) 3,000 lb
- C) 4,500 lb ✓
- D) 10,000 lb

Answer: C — Brakes are required on trailers over 4,500 lb. (§14 Brakes)

16. After becoming a Texas resident, out-of-state plates are recognized for:

- A) 10 days
- B) 20 days
- C) 30 days ✓
- D) 60 days

Answer: C — Out-of-state plates are good for 30 days after residency or employment. (§14 Registration)

17. A buyer's temporary cardboard tag is valid for:

- A) 20 days ✓
- B) 30 days
- C) 45 days
- D) 60 days

Answer: A — A temporary buyer's tag is valid 20 days. (§14 Registration)

18. Mud flaps must reach to within what distance of the road?

- A) 4 inches
- B) 6 inches
- C) 8 inches ✓
- D) 12 inches

Answer: C — Mud flaps must reach within 8 inches of the road. (§14 Equipment)

19. When passing a motorcycle, you must allow at least:

- A) 3 feet
- B) 6 feet ✓
- C) 9 feet
- D) 12 feet

Answer: B — Allow at least 6 feet and change lanes to pass. (§14 Sharing the Road)

20. A single vehicle (not a truck-tractor) may not be longer than:

- A) 40 feet
- B) 45 feet ✓
- C) 53 feet
- D) 65 feet

Answer: B — A single vehicle is limited to 45 feet. (§14 Size and Weight)

21. The maximum number of vehicles allowed in one combination is:

- A) 2
- B) 3 ✓
- C) 4
- D) 5

Answer: B — No more than three vehicles may be combined. (§14 Size and Weight)

22. Tail lamps must be plainly visible from the rear at:

- A) 300 ft
- B) 500 ft
- C) 750 ft
- D) 1,000 ft ✓

Answer: D — Tail lamps must be visible 1,000 feet to the rear. (§14 Lighting)

23. A stop lamp must be visible in daylight from at least:

- A) 100 ft
- B) 300 ft ✓**
- C) 500 ft
- D) 1,000 ft

Answer: B — Stop lamps must be visible 300 feet in normal daylight. (§14 Lighting)

24. At night, a load projecting more than 4 feet past the rear must show a:

- A) White flag
- B) Red flag
- C) Red light ✓**
- D) Amber light

Answer: C — At night use a red light (visible 500 ft) instead of the flag. (§14 Flags)

25. Rear reflectors must be mounted at a height of:

- A) 12-48 inches
- B) 24-54 inches
- C) 24-60 inches ✓**
- D) 12-60 inches

Answer: C — Rear reflectors mount 24 to 60 inches above the road. (§14 Lighting)

26. Headlamps must be mounted at a height of:

- A) 12-48 inches
- B) 24-54 inches ✓**
- C) 24-60 inches
- D) 20-50 inches

Answer: B — Headlamps mount 24 to 54 inches high. (§14 Lighting)

27. Outside a city, a truck may not follow another truck closer than:

- A) 100 ft
- B) 200 ft
- C) 300 ft ✓**
- D) 500 ft

Answer: C — Leave at least 300 feet between trucks (passing is still allowed). (§14 Following)

28. You must dim your high beams for an oncoming vehicle within:

- A) 200 ft
- B) 300 ft
- C) 500 ft ✓**
- D) 1,000 ft

Answer: C — Dim high beams within 500 ft of oncoming traffic (300 ft when following). (§14 Lighting)

29. A combination weighing over 3,000 lb must stop from 20 mph within:

- A) 30 ft
- B) 40 ft
- C) 50 ft ✓**
- D) 60 ft

Answer: C — Over 3,000 lb must stop within 50 ft; 3,000 lb or less within 40 ft. (§14 Brakes)

30. Which light color may NOT be shown toward the front of a vehicle?

- A) White
- B) Amber
- C) Red ✓**
- D) All are allowed

Answer: C — Red may not be shown to the front; it is reserved for the rear. (§14 Lighting)

31. At a railroad crossing, a placarded hazmat truck must:

- A) Stop
- B) Check the way is clear
- C) Cross without shifting gears
- D) All of the above ✓

Answer: D — It must stop, make sure the way is clear, and cross without shifting gears. (§14 Railroad Crossings)

32. Which of these is NOT a Texas limit (without a permit)?

- A) Width 102 in
- B) Height 14 ft
- C) Length 45 ft (single)
- D) Gross 100,000 lb ✓

Answer: D — Maximum gross is 80,000 lb, not 100,000; the others are correct limits. (§14 Size and Weight)

33. Tail lamps are visible at ____; stop lamps are visible at ____.

- A) 1,000 ft / 300 ft ✓
- B) 500 ft / 1,000 ft
- C) 300 ft / 1,000 ft
- D) 1,000 ft / 500 ft

Answer: A — Tail lamps 1,000 ft; stop lamps 300 ft in daylight. (§14 Lighting)

34. Headlamps mount at ____; rear reflectors mount at ____.

- A) 24-54 in / 24-60 in ✓
- B) 24-60 in / 24-54 in
- C) both 24-54 in
- D) both 24-60 in

Answer: A — Headlamps 24-54 in; reflectors 24-60 in. (§14 Lighting)

35. When towing a vehicle by chain, which is required?

- A) A white flag on the connection
- B) A connection no longer than 15 feet
- C) Safety chains as a backup
- D) All of the above ✓

Answer: D — A white flag, a connection within 15 feet, and safety chains are all required. (§14 Towing)

36. Which of the following is LEGAL in Texas?

- A) Coasting downhill in neutral
- B) Showing a red light to the front
- C) Covering a gravel load ✓
- D) A hazmat truck skipping a crossing

Answer: C — Covering loose loads is required; the other three are prohibited. (§14 Rules of Operation)

37. In Texas you must hold your CLP for at least how long before the skills test?

- A) 1 day
- B) 14 days ✓
- C) 6 months
- D) No waiting at all

Answer: B — You must hold the commercial learner's permit at least 14 days before the skills test. (§1)

38. The minimum age to drive a CMV across state lines (interstate) is:

- A) 16
- B) 18
- C) 21 ✓
- D) 25

Answer: C — Interstate driving requires age 21; 18 is allowed only intrastate (within Texas). (§1)

39. Texas's 'Move Over / Slow Down' law applies when you pass a stopped:

- A) An ordinary parked car
- B) A stopped emergency or TxDOT vehicle ✓**
- C) A roadside mailbox post
- D) A bicycle on the shoulder

Answer: B — Move over a lane or slow to 20 mph under the limit for stopped emergency, tow, and TxDOT vehicles with lights on. (§2)

40. A CMV stopped on the shoulder must put out warning devices within:

- A) 1 hour
- B) 10 minutes ✓**
- C) 30 minutes
- D) A full day

Answer: B — Place warning devices within 10 minutes of stopping. (§2)

41. On a two-lane road, you place the three warning triangles at about:

- A) All bunched in one spot
- B) 10 ft, 100 ft, and 100 ft from the vehicle ✓**
- C) Only directly behind it
- D) At 200 ft only, nowhere else

Answer: B — One about 10 ft, one about 100 ft behind, and one about 100 ft ahead on a two-way road. (§2)

42. Required emergency equipment on a CMV includes:

- A) Just a single spare tire
- B) A fire extinguisher, fuses, and triangles ✓**
- C) Only a basic first-aid kit
- D) No special equipment at all

Answer: B — Carry a charged fire extinguisher, spare fuses (if used), and three warning triangles. (§2.1)

43. How many reflective warning triangles must a CMV carry?

- A) One
- B) Two
- C) Three ✓**
- D) Six

Answer: C — Carry three reflective triangles (or equivalent warning devices). (§2.1)

44. In Texas, headlights are required during which hours?

- A) From around noon until midnight
- B) 30 min after sunset to 30 min before sunrise ✓**
- C) Only right around midnight
- D) From sunrise through to sunset

Answer: B — Use headlights from 30 minutes after sunset to 30 minutes before sunrise, and when visibility is low. (§2.11)

45. In Texas you must also use headlights when:

- A) Only on rural dirt roads
- B) Windshield wipers are on in rain ✓**
- C) Never during the daytime
- D) Only while it is parked

Answer: B — Texas law requires headlights when weather requires windshield wipers. (§2.11)

46. On an undivided road, you must stop for a school bus with red lights flashing:

- A) Only if you are behind it
- B) From both directions ✓**
- C) Never at all
- D) Only after dark

Answer: B — On undivided roads, traffic in both directions must stop; a physical median exempts oncoming traffic. (§2)

47. A load wider or taller than Texas legal limits requires:

- A) Nothing extra at all
- B) An oversize/overweight permit ✓**
- C) Only a single red flag
- D) A police escort every time

Answer: B — Loads over legal size or weight need a TxDMV oversize/overweight permit. (§14)

48. A first major offense such as DUI in a CMV disqualifies your CDL for at least:

- A) 30 days
- B) 1 year ✓**
- C) 1 week
- D) No time at all

Answer: B — A first major violation (such as DUI) disqualifies you for at least one year. (§1.4)

49. To get a Texas CDL you must also pass a:

- A) A timed swim test
- B) DOT medical (physical) exam ✓**
- C) A fast typing test
- D) A basic cooking test

Answer: B — A valid DOT medical certificate (physical exam) is required. (§1)

50. In the city, you should signal a turn:

- A) Right at the corner
- B) About 100 feet before ✓**
- C) After you turn
- D) No signal is needed

Answer: B — Signal continuously for about 100 feet before turning. (§2.4)

51. When disabled on the highway, you should turn on the:

- A) Your bright high beams
- B) Four-way flashers (hazard lights) ✓**
- C) The interior dome light
- D) Just the turn signal

Answer: B — Use four-way hazard flashers and set out warning devices. (§2)

52. In Texas, the driver and front passengers must:

- A) Stand up straight
- B) Wear a seat belt ✓**
- C) Keep windows open
- D) Remove the headrests

Answer: B — Seat belt use is required by Texas law. (§2)

53. A commercial driver using a hand-held phone while driving is:

- A) Completely allowed
- B) Breaking federal/Texas rules ✓**
- C) Required by law
- D) Fine inside the city

Answer: B — Hand-held phone use and texting are prohibited for CMV drivers. (§2.8)

54. On a divided highway, a warning triangle toward approaching traffic goes about:

- A) 10 ft back
- B) 100 ft back
- C) 200 ft back ✓**
- D) Right at the bumper

Answer: C — On a divided or one-way road, place devices about 10, 100, and 200 ft toward approaching traffic. (§2)

55. Texas requires drivers to carry proof of:

- A) A monthly gym membership
- B) Financial responsibility (insurance) ✓**
- C) A valid travel passport
- D) A public library card

Answer: B — Proof of financial responsibility (liability insurance) is required. (§1)

56. When you must park, the safest choice is to:

- A) Block a travel lane
- B) Park as far off the road as possible ✓**
- C) Leave it running in a lane
- D) Park on a blind curve

Answer: B — Get the vehicle completely off the traveled road where possible. (§2)

57. A driver who refuses a required alcohol or drug test:

- A) Just gets a written warning
- B) Is disqualified like a failed test ✓**
- C) Gets a small discount
- D) Nothing happens at all

Answer: B — Refusing a required test brings the same disqualification as failing it. (§1.4)

58. Spare electrical fuses must be carried unless the vehicle:

- A) Is painted bright red
- B) Uses circuit breakers, not fuses ✓**
- C) Is brand-new from the lot
- D) Has a working radio

Answer: B — Spare fuses are required unless the vehicle uses circuit breakers. (§2.1)

59. In Texas, open alcohol containers in a CMV cab are:

- A) Generally allowed
- B) Prohibited ✓**
- C) Required
- D) Fine when parked

Answer: B — Possessing or drinking alcohol in a commercial vehicle on duty is prohibited. (§1.4)

60. A driver vehicle inspection report (DVIR) is completed:

- A)** Just once a year
- B) Each day, as required ✓**
- C)** Never at all
- D)** Only when it is sold

Answer: B — Drivers complete a vehicle inspection report as required (daily or after the trip). (§2.1)

General Knowledge · 88 questions

1. What is the minimum tread depth for front (steer) tires?

- A) 2/32 inch
- B) 4/32 inch ✓**
- C) 6/32 inch
- D) 8/32 inch

Answer: B — Steer tires need at least 4/32 inch; other tires 2/32 inch. (§2.1 Inspection)

2. Minimum tread depth for tires other than the front is:

- A) 1/32 inch
- B) 2/32 inch ✓**
- C) 4/32 inch
- D) 6/32 inch

Answer: B — Non-steer tires need at least 2/32 inch. (§2.1 Inspection)

3. How much steering-wheel play should make you suspect a problem?

- A) More than 5 degrees
- B) More than 10 degrees ✓**
- C) More than 20 degrees
- D) More than 45 degrees

Answer: B — More than about 10 degrees (2 in on a 20-in wheel) is too much. (§2.1 Inspection)

4. How many reflective warning triangles must you carry?

- A) One
- B) Two
- C) Three ✓**
- D) Six

Answer: C — Three reflective triangles (or 6 fusees / 3 liquid flares). (§2.1 Inspection)

5. Which fire extinguisher rating works on fuel and electrical fires?

- A) Class A
- B) B:C ✓**
- C) Water type
- D) None work

Answer: B — A B:C extinguisher works on burning liquids and electrical fires. (§2.20 Fires)

6. You must carry spare electrical fuses unless the vehicle has:

- A) Circuit breakers ✓**
- B) A spare battery
- C) LED lights
- D) Two alternators

Answer: A — Spare fuses are required unless the vehicle uses circuit breakers. (§2.1 Inspection)

7. The first step of the seven-step inspection is:

- A) Check the lights
- B) Vehicle overview ✓**
- C) Start the engine
- D) Check the brakes

Answer: B — Step 1 is the vehicle overview. (§2.1 Inspection)

8. With the engine off, the inspection includes checking:

- A) Tire pressure only
- B) Oil, coolant and belts ✓**
- C) Fifth-wheel grease
- D) The radio

Answer: B — Check oil, coolant, power-steering fluid, belts and leaks. (§2.1 Inspection)

9. Accelerating on a slippery road should be done:

- A) Smoothly and gradually ✓**
- B) As fast as possible
- C) With the clutch out
- D) In high gear

Answer: A — Speed up smoothly; too much power can spin the drive wheels. (§2.2 Basic Control)

10. When backing, you should generally:

- A) Back toward the right
- B) Back toward the driver's side ✓**
- C) Back quickly
- D) Use mirrors only

Answer: B — Back toward the driver's side, use a helper, and go slowly. (§2.2 Basic Control)

11. You should downshift to the right gear:

- A) In the curve
- B) Before a hill or curve ✓**
- C) After the curve
- D) Never on grades

Answer: B — Select the gear before the hill or curve. (§2.3 Shifting)

12. Total stopping distance is made up of:

- A) Braking only
- B) Perception + reaction + braking ✓**
- C) Reaction + braking
- D) Perception + braking

Answer: B — Perception plus reaction plus braking distance. (§2.6 Speed)

13. At 55 mph in good conditions, total stopping distance is about:

- A) 140 ft
- B) 220 ft
- C) 320 ft
- D) 420 ft ✓**

Answer: D — About 419 ft at 55 mph. (§2.6 Speed)

14. If you double your speed, braking distance increases about:

- A) 2 times
- B) 3 times
- C) 4 times ✓**
- D) 10 times

Answer: C — Braking distance grows with the square of speed — about 4 times. (§2.6 Speed)

15. On a wet road you should reduce speed by about:

- A) One-tenth
- B) One-third ✓**
- C) One-half
- D) Three-quarters

Answer: B — About one-third on wet roads (half on packed snow). (§2.6 Speed)

16. Compared with a loaded truck, an empty truck usually:

- A) Stops sooner
- B) Needs a longer stop ✓**
- C) Cannot skid
- D) Has more traction

Answer: B — Empty trucks have less traction; wheels can lock and skid. (§2.6 Speed)

17. If your vehicle starts to hydroplane, you should:

- A) Brake hard
- B) Release the accelerator ✓**
- C) Steer sharply
- D) Accelerate

Answer: B — Release the accelerator and push in the clutch; don't brake hard. (§2.6 Speed)

18. Brake fade is most often caused by:

- A) Cold weather
- B) Overheating from overuse ✓**
- C) Low tire pressure
- D) Air in the lines

Answer: B — Heat from using the brakes too much instead of engine braking. (§2.15 Mountain)

19. Posted curve speed limits are set for:

- A) Loaded trucks
- B) Cars in good conditions ✓**
- C) Buses
- D) Empty trucks

Answer: B — They are for cars; slow well below them in a truck. (§2.6 Speed)

20. The following-distance rule for a heavy vehicle is:

- A) Always a flat 2 seconds
- B) 1 second per 10 ft, +1 over 40 mph ✓**
- C) About three car lengths
- D) 100 ft at any road speed

Answer: B — One second per 10 ft of length; add one second over 40 mph. (§2.7 Space)

21. How far ahead should you look while driving?

- A) Just past the hood
- B) 4 to 6 seconds
- C) 12 to 15 seconds ✓**
- D) 30 seconds

Answer: C — Look 12 to 15 seconds ahead. (§2.4 Seeing)

22. You should signal a turn:

- A) Only if cars are near
- B) Early and continuously ✓**
- C) After you start turning
- D) With your hand only

Answer: B — Signal early and keep signaling through the turn. (§2.5 Communicating)

23. If you are being tailgated, you should:

- A) Speed up
- B) Open up room ahead ✓**
- C) Brake-check them
- D) Slow in the left lane

Answer: B — Increase space ahead so you can slow gradually; avoid quick moves. (§2.7 Space)

24. Before turning right, you should NOT:

- A) Turn slowly
- B) Swing wide left first ✓**
- C) Keep the rear near the curb
- D) Check your mirrors

Answer: B — Swinging left invites a pass on your right; turn wide as you finish. (§2.7 Space)

25. Posted clearance heights at bridges:

- A) Are always exact
- B) Should not be fully trusted ✓**
- C) Apply only to cars
- D) Increase when loaded

Answer: B — Repaving or snow can reduce clearance; an empty van rides higher. (§2.7 Space)

26. Convex (curved) mirrors show:

- A) A magnified close-up
- B) A wider area; objects look farther ✓**
- C) The same as flat mirrors
- D) Only the cab

Answer: B — Wider view, but objects look smaller and farther away. (§2.4 Seeing)

27. A 'hazard' on the road is:

- A) Only a fast-moving speeding car
- B) Any condition or user that could be a danger ✓**
- C) Just plain bad weather
- D) Only an actual crash ahead

Answer: B — Anything that could become an emergency. (§2.8 Hazards)

28. The correct response to an aggressive driver is to:

- A) Race them
- B) Stay out of their way ✓**
- C) Brake-check them
- D) Block them in

Answer: B — Give them room, avoid eye contact, and do not engage. (§2.9 Aggressive)

29. Texting or holding a phone while driving a CMV is:

- A) Allowed below 30 mph
- B) Prohibited ✓**
- C) Fine in light traffic
- D) Banned only for new drivers

Answer: B — Banned; it greatly raises crash risk and can disqualify you. (§2.9 Distracted)

30. Not 'overdriving' your headlights at night means:

- A) Use only low beams
- B) Stop within the lit distance ✓**
- C) Follow another vehicle
- D) Use high beams in fog

Answer: B — Drive slowly enough to stop within the range you can see. (§2.10 Night)

31. To avoid glare from oncoming headlights, look:

- A) Straight back at them
- B) To the right edge of your lane ✓**
- C) Down at your dashboard
- D) Far down at the road

Answer: B — Look toward the right edge/markings until they pass. (§2.10 Night)

32. In dense fog you should use:

- A) Your bright high beams
- B) Low beams and slow down ✓**
- C) Only the hazard flashers
- D) No lights at all

Answer: B — High beams reflect back; use low beams and slow down. (§2.11 Fog)

33. In winter, which usually freezes first?

- A) The open road
- B) Bridges and overpasses ✓**
- C) Hills
- D) Tunnels

Answer: B — Bridges freeze before the road. (§2.12 Winter)

34. The road looks wet but tires throw no spray in the cold. This is likely:

- A) Drying pavement
- B) Black ice ✓**
- C) Fresh asphalt
- D) A dirty windshield

Answer: B — Black ice — slow down, no sudden steering or braking. (§2.12 Winter)

35. In very hot weather you should especially check:

- A) Tire pressure ✓**
- B) The horn
- C) The radio
- D) Window tint

Answer: A — Heat raises tire pressure; check tires and coolant. (§2.13 Hot Weather)

36. On a long downgrade, speed is controlled mainly by:

- A) Constantly riding the brakes
- B) A low gear and engine braking ✓**
- C) Just the parking brake
- D) Coasting in neutral

Answer: B — Engine braking in a low gear; brakes only supplement. (§2.15 Mountain)

37. A runaway-truck escape ramp should be used when:

- A) You want a break
- B) Your brakes fail on a grade ✓**
- C) You are slightly speeding
- D) Traffic is heavy

Answer: B — Use it if your brakes fail and you cannot stop. (§2.15 Mountain)

38. If a front tire blows out, your first action is to:

- A) Brake hard right away
- B) Hold the wheel, stay off the brake ✓**
- C) Steer sharply aside
- D) Shift into neutral gear

Answer: B — Grip the wheel, stay off the brake, let it slow, then ease off the road. (§2.16 Emergencies)

39. If your hydraulic brakes fail, first try to:

- A) Pump the brake pedal ✓**
- B) Turn off the engine
- C) Pull the trailer knob
- D) Steer into traffic

Answer: A — Pump to build pressure, then downshift and use the parking brake. (§2.16 Emergencies)

40. To recover from a drive-wheel (rear) skid, you should:

- A) Brake even harder
- B) Stop accelerating and steer ✓**
- C) Lock up all the brakes
- D) Speed up to pull out

Answer: B — Ease off the accelerator and steer where you want to go. (§2.18 Skids)

41. A front-wheel skid is usually caused by:

- A) Braking too gently
- B) Driving too fast for conditions ✓**
- C) Too much rear weight
- D) Engine braking

Answer: B — Going too fast (or worn/under-inflated front tires); slow down. (§2.18 Skids)

42. The main benefit of ABS in a hard stop is:

- A) A shorter stop every time
- B) Keeping steering control ✓**
- C) No need for following space
- D) Automatic steering

Answer: B — Prevents lockup so you can steer; not necessarily a shorter stop. (§2.17 ABS)

43. First at an accident scene, you should:

- A) Move the injured people
- B) Protect the area with warning devices ✓**
- C) Leave to find a phone
- D) Push the wrecks aside fast

Answer: B — Prevent another crash first; usually do not move the injured. (§2.19 Accidents)

44. For an engine fire you should:

- A) Open the hood up wide
- B) Keep the hood down if you can ✓**
- C) Add more diesel fuel
- D) Drive faster to the shop

Answer: B — Opening the hood adds oxygen; shut off the engine. (§2.20 Fires)

45. The blood alcohol limit for driving a CMV is:

- A) 0.10%
- B) 0.08%
- C) 0.04% ✓**
- D) 0.02%

Answer: C — 0.04% or more is a violation for CMV drivers. (§2.21 Alcohol)

46. What actually makes a drinker sober?

- A) Coffee
- B) A cold shower
- C) Fresh air
- D) Time ✓**

Answer: D — Only time removes alcohol from the body. (§2.21 Alcohol)

47. A driver with detectable alcohol under 0.04% will be:

- A) Warned only
- B) Out of service for 24 hours ✓**
- C) Disqualified for life
- D) Fined and released

Answer: B — Out of service 24 hours; 0.04% or more is a DUI offense. (§2.21 Alcohol)

48. You should inspect your cargo within the first:

- A) 10 miles
- B) 50 miles ✓**
- C) 100 miles
- D) 150 miles

Answer: B — Within 50 miles, then every 150 miles or 3 hours. (§3.1 Cargo)

49. The minimum tie-down rule for cargo is:

- A) Just one tie-down total
- B) One per 10 ft, at least two ✓**
- C) One for every 25 ft
- D) Only loads over 20 ft

Answer: B — At least one per 10 ft, minimum two. (§3.2 Cargo)

50. A high center of gravity makes a vehicle:

- A) More stable
- B) More likely to roll over ✓**
- C) Easier to stop
- D) Better in curves

Answer: B — More top-heavy; load heavy cargo low. (§3.1 Cargo)

51. A Texas Class A CDL is for combinations with a GCWR of:

- A) 16,001 lb or more total
- B) 26,001 lb+ towing over 10,000 lb ✓**
- C) 10,000 lb or more total
- D) 40,000 lb or more total

Answer: B — GCWR 26,001+ where the towed unit is over 10,000 lb. (§1 CDL Classes)

52. You get an air-brake restriction if you:

- A) Pass the air-brake test
- B) Test in a vehicle without air brakes ✓**
- C) Drive at night
- D) Have a clean record

Answer: B — Failing or skipping the air-brake test (or testing without them) restricts you. (§1 Restrictions)

53. At a railroad crossing, buses with passengers and placarded hazmat must:

- A) Slow only
- B) Always stop ✓**
- C) Speed up
- D) Ignore it

Answer: B — They must stop, even when no train is visible. (§2.14 Railroad)

54. A typical tractor-trailer clears a single track in about:

- A) 3 seconds
- B) At least 14 seconds ✓**
- C) 1 second
- D) Time does not matter

Answer: B — At least 14 seconds (over 15 for a double track). (§2.14 Railroad)

55. In low light or rain, turn on your headlights mainly to:

- A) Save fuel
- B) Be seen by others ✓**
- C) Warm the engine
- D) Charge the battery

Answer: B — Headlights (not just markers) make you visible. (§2.5 Communicating)

56. A header board ('headache rack') is there to:

- A) To hold the spare tire in place
- B) Stop cargo from shifting into the cab ✓**
- C) To save a little bit of fuel
- D) To mark an extra-wide load

Answer: B — It protects you from forward-shifting cargo. (§3.2 Cargo)

57. Which tire condition is a defect?

- A) Tread over 4/32 in front
- B) Dual tires touching ✓**
- C) Matching tire sizes
- D) Proper inflation

Answer: B — Dual tires must not touch; do not mix radial and bias-ply. (§2.1 Inspection)

58. Which is a sign you are too tired to drive?

- A) Drifting in your lane
- B) Heavy eyelids
- C) Not recalling the last few miles
- D) All of the above ✓**

Answer: D — All are danger signs of fatigue — stop and rest. (§2.22 Fatigue)

59. Which is NOT required emergency equipment?

- A) Fire extinguisher
- B) Spare fuses (no breakers)
- C) Three triangles
- D) A spare tire ✓**

Answer: D — A spare tire is not required; the others are. (§2.1 Inspection)

60. Which is NOT a correct way to handle a skid?

- A) Stop braking
- B) Steer where you want to go
- C) Keep accelerating ✓**
- D) Countersteer as it straightens

Answer: C — Do not keep accelerating; ease off and steer. (§2.18 Skids)

61. Why should you inspect the vehicle before a trip?

- A) To find safety defects
- B) Because the law requires it
- C) To prevent breakdowns
- D) All of the above ✓**

Answer: D — All three — safety, legal duty, and avoiding breakdowns. (§2.1 Inspection)

62. Stopping is not always the safest action because:

- A) It just wastes your time
- B) Steering away can be quicker ✓**
- C) The brakes will overheat
- D) It is against the law

Answer: B — You can often steer to miss a hazard faster than you can stop. (§2.16 Emergencies)

63. Which is the correct order of the stopping-distance parts?

- A) Braking, reaction, perception
- B) Perception, reaction, braking ✓**
- C) Reaction, braking, perception
- D) Perception, braking, reaction

Answer: B — Perceive, react, then brake. (§2.6 Speed)

64. To warn drivers behind that you are slowing a lot, you should:

- A) Just do nothing at all
- B) Tap the brake to flash the lights ✓**
- C) Switch on your high beams
- D) Honk the horn repeatedly

Answer: B — Tap the brakes to flash early, or use hazards if very slow. (§2.5 Communicating)

65. The CDL blood alcohol limit while driving a CMV is:

- A) 0.08%
- B) 0.04% ✓**
- C) 0.10%
- D) 0.02%

Answer: B — A CDL driver is legally intoxicated at 0.04% BAC — half the limit for car drivers. (§1.4)

66. If your brakes fail on a long downgrade, you should:

- A) Pump harder and hope
- B) Use an escape ramp if there is one ✓**
- C) Shift into neutral
- D) Open the door and jump

Answer: B — Runaway escape ramps are built to stop vehicles with failed brakes. (§2.7)

67. Hydroplaning is most likely when:

- A) The road surface is dry
- B) There is water and you drive too fast ✓**
- C) You are driving very slowly
- D) The tires are brand-new ones

Answer: B — Hydroplaning happens on wet roads at higher speeds; slow down. (§2.6)

68. To check tire inflation correctly, you should:

- A) Kick the tire hard
- B) Use a gauge when the tires are cool ✓**
- C) Just look at the tire
- D) Press it with your hand

Answer: B — Use a pressure gauge and check when tires are cool for an accurate reading. (§2.1)

69. The 'No-Zone' refers to:

- A) A highway rest area
- B) A truck's large blind spots ✓**
- C) A toll-only lane
- D) A no-parking curb

Answer: B — The No-Zone is the area around a truck where other vehicles disappear from view. (§2.4)

70. When backing, the safest practice is to:

- A) Back toward the blind right side
- B) Back toward your left side and use a helper ✓**
- C) Back as fast as you can
- D) Skip using your mirrors

Answer: B — Back toward the driver's side when possible and use a helper or spotter. (§2.2)

71. Sometimes the best way to avoid a crash is to:

- A) Always brake as hard as you can
- B) Steer around the hazard ✓**
- C) Close your eyes and brace
- D) Speed straight through it

Answer: B — You often can steer around an obstacle in less distance than it takes to stop. (§2.7)

72. A safe driver gives turn signals:

- A) Right after the turn
- B) Well before the turn ✓**
- C) Only at night
- D) Only on highways

Answer: B — Signal early and keep signaling so others know your intentions. (§2.4)

73. On a slippery road, an engine brake or retarder should usually be:

- A) Turned on fully
- B) Turned off ✓**
- C) Used at maximum
- D) Removed entirely

Answer: B — Retarders can make the drive wheels skid on slick roads, so switch them off. (§2.6)

74. Going up a long, steep grade, you should:

- A) Stay in overdrive
- B) Shift to a lower gear for power ✓**
- C) Coast in neutral
- D) Switch the engine off

Answer: B — On a steep upgrade, select a lower gear to keep engine power and a steady speed. (§2.6)

75. If you double your speed, braking distance roughly:

- A) Stays roughly the same
- B) Increases about four times ✓**
- C) Only doubles, nothing more
- D) Is cut roughly in half

Answer: B — Braking distance grows with the square of speed — about four times when speed doubles. (§2.6)

76. The only sure cure for driving fatigue is to:

- A) Open a window wide
- B) Stop and rest or sleep ✓**
- C) Turn the music up
- D) Drink coffee and keep going

Answer: B — Rest or sleep is the only real fix for fatigue; pull over somewhere safe. (§2.8)

77. Texting while driving a CMV is:

- A) Allowed at red lights
- B) Prohibited ✓**
- C) Required by law
- D) Fine on the highway

Answer: B — Texting and hand-held phone use are prohibited for CMV drivers. (§2.8)

78. In a work zone you should:

- A) Speed up to clear it fast
- B) Slow down and watch for workers ✓**
- C) Change lanes quickly
- D) Follow closely to save time

Answer: B — Reduce speed, keep space, and watch for workers; fines are often doubled. (§2.4)

79. Cargo with a high center of gravity makes the vehicle:

- A) More stable and steady
- B) More likely to roll over ✓**
- C) Noticeably faster
- D) Much lighter

Answer: B — A high center of gravity raises rollover risk; load heavy items low. (§3.2)

80. The combined working load limit of tie-downs must be at least:

- A) A quarter of the cargo weight
- B) Half of the cargo weight ✓**
- C) Twice the cargo weight
- D) Equal to the truck weight

Answer: B — Combined tie-down WLL must be at least one-half the weight of the cargo secured. (§3.2)

81. When making a right turn, you should:

- A) Swing wide to the left first
- B) Keep right and not swing wide ✓**
- C) Speed up through it
- D) Skip the turn signal

Answer: B — Do not swing left before a right turn; it lets others try to pass on the right. (§2.4)

82. Posted curve speeds are set for:

- A) Loaded heavy trucks
- B) Cars in good conditions ✓**
- C) Completely empty roads
- D) Night driving only

Answer: B — Posted curve speeds are for cars; heavy trucks should go slower. (§2.6)

83. Brake fade on a long hill is caused by:

- A) Cold, fresh brakes
- B) Overheated, overused brakes ✓**
- C) Brand-new brake shoes
- D) A very light load

Answer: B — Riding the brakes overheats them until they fade; use a low gear and engine braking. (§2.7)

84. Antilock brakes (ABS) mainly help you:

- A) Always stop in a shorter distance
- B) Keep steering control in a hard stop ✓**
- C) Save a lot of fuel
- D) Skip the brake inspection

Answer: B — ABS keeps wheels from locking so you can steer; it does not necessarily shorten stops. (§5.3)

85. Compared with loaded trucks, empty trucks:

- A) Always stop more quickly
- B) May take longer to stop ✓**
- C) Can never skid
- D) Have much more traction

Answer: B — Empty trucks have less traction and can bounce, taking longer to stop. (§2.6)

86. You should turn on your headlights:

- A) Only around midnight
- B) At dusk and in rain, fog, or low light ✓**
- C) Never while it is raining
- D) Only out on the highway

Answer: B — Use headlights in low light and bad weather so others can see you. (§2.11)

87. Convex (curved) mirrors:

- A) Make objects look much closer
- B) Show more area but make things look farther ✓**
- C) Show nothing useful at all
- D) Are not allowed on big trucks

Answer: B — Convex mirrors show a wider area, but objects appear smaller and farther than they are. (§2.4)

88. The first thing to do when you spot a hazard ahead is:

- A)** Ignore it and drive on
- B) Get ready to react and adjust ✓**
- C)** Speed up to pass it
- D)** Just honk your horn

Answer: B — Spotting a hazard early gives you time to plan and act before an emergency. (\$2.5)

Air Brakes · 64 questions

1. An air brake system is really how many separate systems?

- A) One
- B) Two
- C) **Three ✓**
- D) Four

Answer: C — Three: service, parking, and emergency. (§5.1 Parts)

2. The governor stops the compressor (cut-out) at about:

- A) 100 psi
- B) 110 psi
- C) **125 psi ✓**
- D) 150 psi

Answer: C — Cut-out is usually around 125 psi (cut-in around 100 psi). (§5.1 Governor)

3. The governor lets the compressor start again (cut-in) at about:

- A) 60 psi
- B) **100 psi ✓**
- C) 140 psi
- D) 150 psi

Answer: B — Cut-in is about 100 psi. (§5.1 Governor)

4. The safety relief valve usually opens at:

- A) 100 psi
- B) 125 psi
- C) **150 psi ✓**
- D) 200 psi

Answer: C — It opens at about 150 psi to protect the system. (§5.1 Reservoirs)

5. The low-air warning must come on before pressure falls below:

- A) 40 psi
- B) 55 psi
- C) **60 psi ✓**
- D) 80 psi

Answer: C — Before 60 psi (Texas handbook). (§5.1 Warning)

6. Spring (emergency) brakes apply automatically at about:

- A) 5–10 psi
- B) **20–45 psi ✓**
- C) 60 psi
- D) 100 psi

Answer: B — They come on at about 20–45 psi. (§5.1 Spring Brakes)

7. The brake pedal in an air system is also called the:

- A) Governor
- B) **Foot (treadle) valve ✓**
- C) Slack adjuster
- D) Glad hand

Answer: B — The foot/treadle valve sends air to the brakes. (§5.1 Parts)

8. Air tanks must be drained to remove:

- A) Air
- B) Water and oil ✓**
- C) Brake fluid
- D) Coolant

Answer: B — Compressed air collects water and some oil. (§5.1 Tanks)

9. What does an air dryer do?

- A) Raises pressure
- B) Removes moisture ✓**
- C) Cools the brakes
- D) Warns of low air

Answer: B — It removes water and contaminants from the air. (§5.1 Parts)

10. The supply pressure gauge shows:

- A) Tank pressure ✓**
- B) Pressure applied to brakes
- C) Engine oil pressure
- D) Tire pressure

Answer: A — It shows how much air is in the tanks. (§5.1 Gauges)

11. The application pressure gauge shows:

- A) The air tank pressure
- B) Pressure applied to the brakes ✓**
- C) The engine rpm reading
- D) The tire inflation pressure

Answer: B — It shows how much pressure you are applying. (§5.1 Gauges)

12. Pressing the brakes twists the S-cam, which:

- A) Drains the tanks
- B) Spreads the brake shoes ✓**
- C) Closes the governor
- D) Raises the trailer

Answer: B — The S-cam forces the shoes against the drum. (§5.1 Parts)

13. A manual slack adjuster should move no more than about:

- A) 1 inch ✓**
- B) 3 inches
- C) 5 inches
- D) It can move freely

Answer: A — More than about an inch means brakes are out of adjustment. (§5.3 Inspection)

14. Air brake lag is about:

- A) 1/10 second
- B) 1/2 second ✓**
- C) 2 seconds
- D) 5 seconds

Answer: B — About half a second for air to act after the pedal. (§5.4 Using)

15. Air-brake stopping distance adds which extra part?

- A) Perception
- B) Reaction
- C) Brake lag ✓**
- D) Nothing extra

Answer: C — Perception + reaction + brake lag + braking. (§5.4 Using)

16. Engine off, brakes released, single vehicle: air loss should be under:

- A) 2 psi/min ✓**
- B) 3 psi/min
- C) 4 psi/min
- D) 6 psi/min

Answer: A — Single under 2 psi/min; combination under 3. (§5.3 Inspection)

17. Engine off, brakes released, combination: air loss should be under:

- A) 2 psi/min
- B) 3 psi/min ✓**
- C) 4 psi/min
- D) 6 psi/min

Answer: B — Combination under 3 psi/min released. (§5.3 Inspection)

18. With the brakes applied, a single vehicle should lose under:

- A) 2 psi/min
- B) 3 psi/min ✓**
- C) 4 psi/min
- D) 6 psi/min

Answer: B — Applied: single under 3, combination under 4. (§5.3 Inspection)

19. In a dual system, pressure should build 85 to 100 psi within:

- A) 10 seconds
- B) 45 seconds ✓**
- C) 3 minutes
- D) 5 minutes

Answer: B — Within 45 seconds at operating rpm. (§5.3 Inspection)

20. To test the low-air warning, you:

- A) Pump up the pressure
- B) Fan it down until it lights ✓**
- C) Drain all the air fast
- D) Turn off the lights

Answer: B — Fan the brakes down; the warning must light by 60 psi. (§5.3 Inspection)

21. To test the service brakes, you:

- A) Brake hard from highway speed
- B) Roll at 5 mph and brake firmly ✓**
- C) Only test the parking brake
- D) Pump ten times

Answer: B — At 5 mph, brake firmly; it should stop straight, no pulling. (§5.3 Inspection)

22. A brake drum is unsafe if a crack is longer than:

- A) A hairline
- B) Half the friction width ✓**
- C) Any length
- D) Drums never crack

Answer: B — Cracks over half the friction width are out of service. (§5.3 Inspection)

23. Brake linings are defective if they are:

- A) Thick and dry
- B) Oil-soaked or too thin ✓**
- C) Newly replaced
- D) Properly seated

Answer: B — Loose, oil-soaked, or dangerously thin linings are bad. (§5.3 Inspection)

24. On a long downgrade, the brakes should be:

- A) The main speed control
- B) A supplement to engine braking ✓**
- C) Held down lightly
- D) Pumped constantly

Answer: B — Engine braking in a low gear is primary; brakes supplement. (§5.4 Downgrades)

25. In the snub-braking method, you:

- A) Hold light pressure all the way
- B) Brake firmly, release, and repeat ✓**
- C) Pump rapidly
- D) Coast in neutral

Answer: B — Brake to about 5 mph below your safe speed, release, repeat. (§5.4 Downgrades)

26. Fanning (pumping) the brakes on a long grade:

- A) Saves the brakes
- B) Wastes air and can lose pressure ✓**
- C) Builds pressure faster
- D) Cools the engine

Answer: B — Air can drop until the brakes fail; use a low gear instead. (§5.4 Using)

27. You should NOT set the parking brakes when:

- A) Parked overnight
- B) The brakes are very hot ✓**
- C) On level ground
- D) After a short trip

Answer: B — Hot brakes can be damaged or freeze; chock the wheels. (§5.4 Parking)

28. If the low-air warning comes on while driving, you should:

- A) Keep going to the next town
- B) Stop and park as soon as safe ✓**
- C) Turn off the warning
- D) Speed up to build air

Answer: B — Loss of air can apply the spring brakes suddenly. (§5.4 Using)

29. With ABS, you make an emergency stop by:

- A) Pumping the pedal
- B) Braking hard and holding ✓**
- C) Using only the trailer brakes
- D) Releasing at each skid

Answer: B — Brake fully and keep steering; ABS prevents lockup. (§5.4 ABS)

30. Without ABS, the best hard-stop method is:

- A) Locking the wheels
- B) Controlled or stab braking ✓**
- C) Pressing to the floor
- D) Pumping the steering

Answer: B — Keep the wheels from staying locked so you can steer. (§5.4 Using)

31. In stab braking, you reapply the brakes:

- A) Almost right away
- B) After the wheels roll again ✓**
- C) After about 10 seconds
- D) Never reapply them

Answer: B — Release when locked; reapply once rolling (up to 1 sec). (§5.4 Using)

32. If your ABS malfunction lamp stays on, you:

- A) Have no brakes
- B) Have normal brakes; fix the ABS ✓**
- C) Must stop the engine
- D) Should pump the brakes

Answer: B — You lose only the anti-lock function; service it soon. (§5.1 ABS)

33. ABS is required on truck tractors built on or after:

- A) 1995
- B) 1997 ✓**
- C) 1998
- D) 2000

Answer: B — Tractors 3/1/1997; other vehicles and trailers 3/1/1998. (§5.1 ABS)

34. If one circuit of a dual system fails while driving:

- A) You lose all braking
- B) The other still stops you ✓**
- C) The engine stops
- D) Only the lights fail

Answer: B — The other circuit still brakes you; the warning comes on. (§5.2 Dual)

35. Why drain the air tanks (or use automatic drains)?

- A) To raise pressure
- B) To remove water that can freeze ✓**
- C) To clean the linings
- D) To reset the governor

Answer: B — Water can freeze the brakes in cold weather. (§5.1 Tanks)

36. Before driving, let the air system charge to:

- A) A low pressure of about 50 psi
- B) The normal range (about 125 psi) ✓**
- C) Exactly 150 psi every time
- D) Almost any pressure level

Answer: B — Charge to the normal operating range before moving. (§5.3 Inspection)

37. Why check the air-compressor drive belt (if belt-driven)?

- A) It quietly runs the cab radio
- B) A loose belt may not build enough air ✓**
- C) It helps cool the wheel brakes
- D) It charges the trailer battery

Answer: B — A slipping belt means the compressor can't keep up. (§5.3 Inspection)

38. A full pre-trip air-brake check includes which test?

- A) Low-air warning
- B) Build-up time
- C) Leak-down rate
- D) All of the above ✓**

Answer: D — All of these are part of the air-brake check. (§5.3 Inspection)

39. Which is NOT a way to test air brakes?

- A) Leak-down test
- B) Build-up time
- C) Draining the radiator ✓**
- D) Low-air warning

Answer: C — The radiator is cooling, not the air-brake system. (§5.3 Inspection)

40. Which is NOT true of ABS?

- A) It prevents wheel lockup
- B) It helps you steer
- C) It always shortens the stop ✓**
- D) It works in hard stops

Answer: C — ABS does not necessarily shorten the stopping distance. (§5.1 ABS)

41. Water and oil collect in the air tanks, so the tanks must be:

- A) Painted over
- B) Drained regularly ✓**
- C) Removed entirely
- D) Filled with oil

Answer: B — Drain the tanks (manually or automatically) to remove water and oil that harm the system. (§5.1)

42. The air compressor is driven by:

- A) The trailer
- B) The engine ✓**
- C) The driver
- D) Plain gravity

Answer: B — The engine drives the air compressor by belt or directly. (§5.1)

43. An air dryer's job is to:

- A) Cool down the cab
- B) Remove moisture from the air ✓**
- C) Add oil to the air
- D) Inflate the tires

Answer: B — The air dryer removes water and some oil before air reaches the tanks. (§5.1)

44. Most heavy vehicles use what kind of foundation brakes?

- A) Small bicycle brakes
- B) S-cam drum brakes ✓**
- C) A hand brake lever
- D) No brakes at all

Answer: B — S-cam drum brakes are the most common type on air-braked vehicles. (§5.1)

45. When you press the brake pedal harder, the brakes:

- A) Get weaker
- B) Get more air and force ✓**
- C) Release fully
- D) Switch off

Answer: B — The foot (treadle) valve sends more air pressure for more braking force. (§5.1)

46. Brake lag is the time it takes for:

- A) The engine to start
- B) Air to apply the brakes ✓**
- C) The tires to warm up
- D) The lights to flash

Answer: B — Air brakes have about a half-second lag before they take hold. (§5.2)

47. With air brakes, total stopping distance also includes:

- A) The tire size
- B) Brake lag distance ✓**
- C) The fuel level
- D) The mirror angle

Answer: B — Add brake-lag distance to perception, reaction, and braking distance. (§5.2)

48. To test the service brakes, you should:

- A) Honk the horn twice
- B) Roll at 5 mph and brake ✓**
- C) Rev the engine hard
- D) Open the engine hood

Answer: B — Move slowly, apply the brakes, and feel the vehicle stop promptly with no pull. (§5.3)

49. Slack adjusters control:

- A) The cab radio
- B) Brake pushrod travel ✓**
- C) The tire pressure
- D) The air horn

Answer: B — Slack adjusters set pushrod travel; too much travel means the brakes need adjustment. (§5.3)

50. A drain valve that empties the tank by itself is called:

- A) A manual drain valve
- B) An automatic drain valve ✓**
- C) A relay valve
- D) A glad hand

Answer: B — Automatic drain valves expel water and oil without manual draining. (§5.1)

51. A dual air brake system has:

- A) A single air tank
- B) Two separate air systems ✓**
- C) No tanks at all
- D) One shared line

Answer: B — Dual systems use separate primary and secondary systems for safety. (§5.1)

52. If one system in a dual air brake setup fails, the other:

- A) Also fails completely
- B) Still works to stop the vehicle ✓**
- C) Suddenly speeds up
- D) Locks on forever

Answer: B — The remaining system can still stop the vehicle, though stopping distance is longer. (§5.1)

53. Spring brakes are held in the released position by:

- A) Plain gravity
- B) Air pressure ✓**
- C) A strong rope
- D) The cab radio

Answer: B — Air pressure holds the powerful springs back; if air is lost, the springs apply the brakes. (§5.1)

54. Because spring-brake springs are so strong, you should:

- A) Release them by hand often
- B) Not release them unless trained ✓**
- C) Paint them bright
- D) Remove them fully

Answer: B — Caging spring brakes is dangerous; only trained personnel should do it. (§5.1)

55. To test that the parking (spring) brakes hold, you should:

- A) Rev the engine loudly
- B) Gently pull forward against them ✓**
- C) Honk the horn twice
- D) Open the cab door

Answer: B — With the parking brake set, gently tug against it to confirm it holds. (§5.3)

56. On a long downgrade with air brakes, you should:

- A) Fan the brakes on and off
- B) Use low gear and steady braking ✓**
- C) Hold the brakes hard throughout
- D) Coast down in neutral

Answer: B — Pick a safe speed, use engine braking in a low gear, and apply the brakes steadily. (§5.3)

57. The brake that the foot pedal controls is the:

- A) The parking brake
- B) The service brake ✓**
- C) The emergency brake
- D) The trailer hand valve

Answer: B — The foot pedal (treadle valve) operates the service brakes. (§5.1)

58. Brake drums or discs are dangerous when they are:

- A) Clean and cool
- B) Cracked or badly worn ✓**
- C) Freshly painted
- D) Cool to the touch

Answer: B — Cracked drums/discs or worn linings can fail and must be inspected. (§5.3)

59. For an air leak that keeps dropping pressure, you should:

- A) Keep on driving anyway
- B) Stop and get it repaired ✓**
- C) Drive faster to a shop
- D) Just ignore the leak

Answer: B — A continuing air leak is dangerous; stop safely and repair before driving. (§5.3)

60. The yellow ABS malfunction lamp staying on means:

- A) The brakes are off
- B) ABS may not be working ✓**
- C) You must stop at once
- D) The cab radio is on

Answer: B — A lit ABS lamp warns the antilock system may not function; normal brakes still work. (§5.3)

61. Air brakes keep working as long as there is:

- A) Plenty of fuel
- B) Enough air pressure ✓**
- C) Bright sunlight
- D) A second passenger

Answer: B — The system needs adequate air pressure to apply and release the brakes. (§5.1)

62. After a full charge, building air from 85 to 100 psi should take:

- A) Several long minutes
- B) A short time, in seconds ✓**
- C) A full hour
- D) No time, instantly

Answer: B — A healthy compressor builds pressure quickly; slow build means a problem. (§5.3)

63. Brake linings that are too thin must be:

- A) Painted over
- B) Replaced with new ones ✓**
- C) Lightly oiled
- D) Left and ignored

Answer: B — Worn linings reduce braking and must be replaced. (§5.3)

64. Pressing and releasing the brakes many times on a hill ('fanning') can:

A) Help cool the brakes

B) Use air faster than it builds ✓

C) Charge the trailer tank

D) Save a little fuel

Answer: B — Fanning air brakes can drop air pressure faster than the compressor rebuilds it. (§5.3)

Combination Vehicles - 60 questions

1. As a long vehicle turns, the rear wheels follow:

- A) The same path as the front
- B) A path inside the front wheels ✓**
- C) A wider path than the front
- D) No predictable path

Answer: B — Off-tracking: the rear wheels cut inside the front path. (§6.1 Driving)

2. To keep the trailer off the curb on a right turn, you:

- A) Swing wide left first
- B) Turn wide as you finish the turn ✓**
- C) Turn sharply early
- D) Speed through it

Answer: B — Keep the rear near the curb; turn wide as you complete the turn. (§6.1 Driving)

3. How many air lines connect the tractor and trailer?

- A) One
- B) Two ✓**
- C) Three
- D) Four

Answer: B — Two: the service line and the emergency (supply) line. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

4. The glad-hand color for the emergency (supply) line is:

- A) Blue
- B) Red ✓**
- C) Green
- D) Yellow

Answer: B — Red = emergency; blue = service. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

5. The red, eight-sided knob in the cab controls the:

- A) Tractor parking brake
- B) Trailer air supply ✓**
- C) Trailer service brakes
- D) Headlights

Answer: B — It is the trailer air supply / emergency line. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

6. The tractor protection valve is there to:

- A) Inflate the tractor and trailer tires
- B) Keep air in the tractor if the trailer breaks away ✓**
- C) Raise and lower the landing gear
- D) Lock the fifth wheel onto the kingpin

Answer: B — It closes to preserve tractor air during a breakaway or leak. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

7. The trailer hand valve should be used:

- A) For parking
- B) Only to test the trailer brakes ✓**
- C) Instead of the foot brake
- D) On every downgrade

Answer: B — Using it to drive can cause a trailer skid. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

8. After coupling, the locking jaws must close around the kingpin's:

- A) Head (top)
- B) Shank (neck) ✓**
- C) Base plate
- D) Release arm

Answer: B — Jaws must close around the shank, not the head. (§6.4 Coupling)

9. How much gap should there be between the fifth-wheel halves?

- A) None ✓**
- B) About 1 inch
- C) About 2 inches
- D) A small gap is fine

Answer: A — No gap; a gap means the kingpin may not be locked. (§6.4 Coupling)

10. The tug test checks the coupling by:

- A) Gently tapping on the trailer
- B) Pulling against locked trailer brakes ✓**
- C) Checking all the trailer lights
- D) Listening for a faint click

Answer: B — Pull gently forward; the trailer should stay attached. (§6.4 Coupling)

11. Before driving, the landing gear should be:

- A) Left partway down
- B) Fully raised, handle secured ✓**
- C) Touching the road surface
- D) Removed and stored away

Answer: B — Fully up so it does not catch; secure the crank handle. (§6.5 Inspection)

12. To make a trailer go right while backing, first turn the wheel:

- A) Right
- B) Left, then follow it ✓**
- C) Straight
- D) You can't steer in reverse

Answer: B — Backing a trailer is opposite; turn left first, then follow. (§6.1 Driving)

13. Glad-hand seals should be:

- A) Removed for a tight fit
- B) In good condition ✓**
- C) Coated with oil
- D) Cross-connected

Answer: B — Worn seals leak air and reduce trailer braking. (§6.4 Coupling)

14. The two keys to preventing a rollover are low cargo and:

- A) High speed in turns
- B) Slow speed in turns ✓**
- C) Hard braking
- D) Quick lane changes

Answer: B — Keep cargo low and centered, and go slowly around turns. (§6.1 Rollover)

15. Compared with an empty one, a fully loaded rig is about:

- A) Half as likely to roll
- B) Just as likely to roll
- C) 10 times more likely to roll ✓**
- D) Unable to roll

Answer: C — A loaded rig has a higher center of gravity. (§6.1 Rollover)

16. A quick, hard steering move can 'crack the whip,' which means:

- A) The tractor cab spins out
- B) The trailer whips and can flip ✓**
- C) The service brakes fade out
- D) The diesel engine stalls

Answer: B — Rearward amplification; steer gently and smoothly. (§6.1 Driving)

17. If your trailer begins to skid, you should:

- A) Use the hand valve
- B) Release the brakes ✓**
- C) Brake harder
- D) Accelerate

Answer: B — Release the brakes so the trailer wheels grip again. (§6.1 Skids)

18. A tractor jackknife starts when the:

- A) Trailer wheels lock
- B) Drive wheels skid ✓**
- C) Steer tires wear
- D) Landing gear drops

Answer: B — A drive-wheel skid swings the tractor; ease off the brake. (§6.1 Skids)

19. A bobtail tractor (no trailer) usually:

- A) Stops much shorter
- B) Takes longer to stop ✓**
- C) Cannot skid
- D) Has the best traction

Answer: B — Little weight on the drive axle means poor traction. (§6.1 Driving)

20. Losing pressure in the emergency line causes:

- A) Nothing at all to happen
- B) The trailer emergency brakes to apply ✓**
- C) The trailer to speed right up
- D) The trailer lights to fail

Answer: B — A breakaway applies the trailer emergency brakes. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

21. The service line carries:

- A) The brake-pedal signal ✓**
- B) Air to inflate tires
- C) Trailer lighting
- D) Nothing while driving

Answer: A — It sends the signal from the brake pedal or hand valve. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

22. The red trailer-air knob pops out by itself at about:

- A) 55-60 psi
- B) 20-45 psi ✓**
- C) 5-10 psi
- D) 100 psi

Answer: B — At 20-45 psi the tractor protection valve closes. (§6.2 Air Brakes)

23. If the glad hands are crossed, you may have:

- A) Brighter lights
- B) No trailer brakes ✓**
- C) A smoother ride
- D) Better fuel use

Answer: B — Crossed lines send air to the wrong place. (§6.4 Coupling)

24. You position the tractor for coupling by:

- A) Backing in at an angle
- B) Lining up directly in front ✓**
- C) Pulling forward over it
- D) Approaching from the side

Answer: B — Never back under at an angle; line up squarely. (§6.4 Coupling)

25. Before backing under, the trailer should be:

- A) Resting on the ground
- B) Low enough to be raised slightly ✓**
- C) Higher than the fifth wheel
- D) At any height

Answer: B — The tractor should raise it slightly when backing under. (§6.4 Coupling)

26. The fifth-wheel release arm should be:

- A) Pulled fully open
- B) Locked, safety latch closed ✓**
- C) Removed completely
- D) Loose and rattling

Answer: B — Engaged/locked with the safety latch over it. (§6.5 Inspection)

27. A sliding fifth wheel must be:

- A) As far forward as possible
- B) Locked with pins engaged ✓**
- C) Left loose
- D) Set only by weight

Answer: B — Locked in place; an unlocked slider is dangerous. (§6.5 Inspection)

28. A sliding fifth wheel set too far forward:

- A) Improves the ride
- B) Overloads the steer axle ✓**
- C) Lightens the steer axle
- D) Has no effect

Answer: B — It puts too much weight on the steer axle and reduces clearance. (§6.5 Inspection)

29. Air and electrical lines should be:

- A) Left dragging for slack
- B) Secured and not dragging ✓**
- C) Coiled very tightly
- D) Disconnected for turns

Answer: B — Dragging lines can be damaged or torn off. (§6.5 Inspection)

30. Mud flaps (splash guards) must be:

- A) Removed for fuel economy
- B) Present and secured ✓**
- C) Dragging on the road
- D) Made of metal

Answer: B — They reduce spray onto following vehicles. (§6.5 Inspection)

31. When uncoupling, before pulling out you should:

- A) Raise the landing gear up
- B) Lower the landing gear to support the trailer ✓**
- C) Release the trailer parking brakes
- D) Drive forward quickly away

Answer: B — Lower the landing gear, disconnect lines, then unlock. (§6.4 Coupling)

32. The trailer's ABS malfunction lamp is usually:

- A) Inside the cab
- B) Yellow, on the left side ✓**
- C) On the kingpin
- D) Not present

Answer: B — If it stays on, the trailer ABS is not working. (§6.3 ABS)

33. To avoid a hazard in a combination, it is usually best to:

- A) Brake hard and steer
- B) Steer smoothly, then back ✓**
- C) Lock the brakes
- D) Use the hand valve

Answer: B — Countersteer smoothly; hard braking can jackknife. (§6.1 Driving)

34. A correct coupling check includes:

- A) No gap at the fifth wheel
- B) Jaws around the kingpin
- C) A successful tug test
- D) All of the above ✓**

Answer: D — All three confirm a safe coupling. (§6.4 Coupling)

35. Which is NOT a coupling step?

- A) Line up the tractor
- B) Back under and lock
- C) Drain the air tanks ✓**
- D) Connect the air lines

Answer: C — Draining the tanks is not part of coupling. (§6.4 Coupling)

36. Your low trailer is stuck on a railroad crossing. You should:

- A) Try to rock it free
- B) Get out and call the posted emergency number ✓**
- C) Unhook the trailer on the tracks
- D) Sit and wait inside the cab

Answer: B — Leave the vehicle and call using the DOT crossing number. (§6.1 Railroad)

37. A combination vehicle is:

- A) A single large city bus
- B) A tractor pulling one or more trailers ✓**
- C) A small pickup truck only
- D) A two-wheeled motorcycle

Answer: B — A combination is a power unit (tractor) coupled to one or more trailers. (§6.1)

38. The trailer's kingpin locks into:

- A) The rear bumper
- B) The fifth wheel's jaws ✓**
- C) A mud flap
- D) The tail light

Answer: B — The kingpin drops into the fifth wheel and the locking jaws close around it. (§6.2)

39. The fifth wheel should be kept:

- A) Dry and rusty
- B) Greased (lubricated) ✓**
- C) Brightly painted
- D) Loose and worn

Answer: B — Keep the fifth wheel properly greased so it pivots and to reduce wear. (§6.3)

40. The flat plate under the front of the trailer that rests on the fifth wheel is the:

- A) The front bumper
- B) The apron ✓**
- C) The engine hood
- D) The dashboard

Answer: B — The trailer apron rests flat on the fifth wheel; the kingpin extends down from it. (§6.2)

41. To confirm the locking jaws closed, you should:

- A) Tap all the tires
- B) Look under with a flashlight ✓**
- C) Honk the horn twice
- D) Check the cab radio

Answer: B — Look directly under the trailer with a light to see the jaws closed around the kingpin. (§6.2)

42. Before backing under a trailer, you set its height so the tractor will:

- A) Crush right down on it
- B) Lift the trailer as it backs under ✓**
- C) Completely miss the trailer
- D) Tip it over to one side

Answer: B — Set trailer height so the tractor lifts it a little as the fifth wheel slides under. (§6.2)

43. The supply (emergency) air line:

- A) Plays the cab radio
- B) Charges the trailer air tanks ✓**
- C) Opens the trailer doors
- D) Cools down the cab

Answer: B — The supply line sends air to fill the trailer's air tanks. (§6.2)

44. The trailer's spring (emergency) brakes come on when:

- A) The cab radio is on
- B) The supply line loses air ✓**
- C) You honk the horn
- D) The marker lights flash

Answer: B — Loss of air in the supply line lets the trailer's spring brakes apply. (§6.2)

45. A longer combination needs ___ following distance:

- A) Much less
- B) More than usual ✓**
- C) No extra
- D) Zero extra

Answer: B — Longer, heavier rigs take longer to stop and need more space. (§6.1)

46. Because the trailer off-tracks, you should start a turn:

- A) Earlier than a car would
- B) A bit later so the trailer clears ✓**
- C) Without using any signal
- D) At full open road speed

Answer: B — Trailer wheels cut inside the tractor's path, so begin the turn a little later and watch the trailer. (§6.1)

47. To park a combination safely, you should:

- A) Leave it parked only in gear
- B) Set the brakes and chock the wheels ✓**
- C) Leave the engine running idle
- D) Lower the trailer roof down

Answer: B — Apply the parking brakes; chock wheels on a grade or when uncoupling. (§6.3)

48. The trailer hand valve should NOT be used:

- A) For a quick brake test
- B) To hold a parked trailer ✓**
- C) On a steep ramp only
- D) On flat ground only

Answer: B — Don't use the hand valve to park — air can leak off and the trailer could roll. (§6.2)

49. Using only the trailer hand valve in a skid can cause:

- A) A smooth, gentle stop
- B) A trailer skid or jackknife ✓**
- C) A much faster trip
- D) A cooler engine

Answer: B — Braking only the trailer with the hand valve can make it skid; use the foot brake. (§6.2)

50. Compared with loaded trailers, empty trailers:

- A) Grip the road better
- B) Bounce and skid more easily ✓**
- C) Always stop faster
- D) Never roll over

Answer: B — Light or empty trailers have less traction and bounce; brake gently. (§6.1)

51. The electrical pigtail between tractor and trailer powers:

- A) The tractor engine
- B) The trailer lights and ABS ✓**
- C) The tractor tires
- D) The fifth wheel

Answer: B — The pigtail cord supplies power for the trailer's lights and antilock system. (§6.2)

52. You should inspect the fifth-wheel mounting for:

- A) A nice clean shiny look
- B) Cracks and loose or missing bolts ✓**
- C) Just exactly the right color
- D) A working cab radio

Answer: B — Check the fifth-wheel platform and mounting bolts for cracks or looseness. (§6.3)

53. A sliding fifth wheel lets you:

- A) Change its color
- B) Shift weight between axles ✓**
- C) Add extra seats
- D) Play loud music

Answer: B — Sliding it adjusts weight distribution over the tractor axles. (§6.2)

54. The trailer air tanks should be:

- A) Painted bright red
- B) Drained of water and oil ✓**
- C) Kept full of water
- D) Removed entirely

Answer: B — Drain the trailer tanks like the tractor's to remove water and oil. (§6.3)

55. After charging the trailer air, you should next:

- A) Completely ignore the brakes
- B) Test that the trailer brakes work ✓**
- C) Remove the air supply lines
- D) Lower the trailer down

Answer: B — After charging, test the trailer service and emergency brakes before the road. (§6.2)

56. A combination is taller than a car, so watch for:

- A) A very low fuel level
- B) Overhead clearance (bridges, signs) ✓**
- C) A loud blaring cab radio
- D) The cold winter weather

Answer: B — Check posted clearances and don't assume they fit; the rig may be too tall. (§6.1)

57. A trailer's marker, clearance, and tail lights must be:

- A) Switched off always
- B) Working and the right colors ✓**
- C) Painted over fully
- D) Removed from the trailer

Answer: B — Trailer lights must work and show the correct colors front and rear. (§6.3)

58. If the kingpin is not locked in the fifth wheel, the trailer can:

- A) Brake much better
- B) Come loose from the tractor ✓**
- C) Go a lot faster
- D) Save extra fuel

Answer: B — An unlocked kingpin can let the trailer separate — always check the jaws. (§6.2)

59. A loaded combination's stopping distance is:

- A) Shorter than a car's
- B) Longer than a lighter vehicle's ✓**
- C) Exactly zero feet
- D) Same as a small car's

Answer: B — Heavier combinations take more distance to stop; keep more space. (§6.1)

60. The walk-around of a coupled rig should include:

- A) Only the tractor cab area itself
- B) Trailer tires, lights, brakes, connections ✓**
- C) Just one side mirror glass
- D) Nothing extra is really needed

Answer: B — Inspect trailer tires, lights, brakes, the coupling, and the air/electrical lines. (§6.3)